

A

Different crimes

A **crime** is an activity that is wrong and not allowed by law. A person who **commits a crime** is a **criminal**.

crime	person	verb
theft [stealing something, e.g. a car]	thief	steal/take (something)
robbery [stealing from a person or place, e.g. a bank]	robber	rob (someone, a place)
burglary [getting into a building, usually someone's home, and stealing something]	burglar	steal something burgle (a place)
murder [killing someone]	murderer	murder

Someone's **stolen/taken** my handbag.
I don't know who **robbed** me.
Our flat was **burgled**, but they only took money.

There's been another **burglary** in the area.
Did you hear about the **bank robbery** yesterday?
Do they know who **murdered** the boy?

B

Reporting crimes in the media

Two women robbed a jeweller's shop in West London early this morning. They **broke in¹ around 7 o'clock and stole jewellery **worth**² over £10,000.**

¹ entered the building using force, e.g. broke a window

² with a value of

BREAKING NEWS

Detectives⁵ **arrested**⁶ a man this morning in connection with the murder of shop assistant, Tracey Miles.

→ [Read full story](#)

The two men **attacked**³ Mr Crawford while he was walking home yesterday afternoon. Police say the two men hit him in the face several times, then took his money and **escaped**⁴ through Bushy Park.

³ used physical violence to hurt him

⁴ left the place to avoid danger; *syn* **got away**

⁵ police officers who try to find information to solve crimes

⁶ If you *arrest* someone, you take them to the police station because you believe they committed a crime. That person is then **under arrest**.

C

Punishment*

If you commit a crime and the police **catch** you [find you and arrest you], you will be **punished**. For **minor offences** [crimes that are not very important; *opp* **serious**], the punishment may only be a **fine** [money you have to pay], but for serious crimes, you will have to go to **court**. If you are found **guilty** [the **judge**, or a **jury** of 12 people, decides you committed the crime; *opp* **innocent**], you may be sent to **prison** (*syn* **jail**).

judge



court



prison

* what a person must suffer if they do something wrong

English Vocabulary in Use Pre-intermediate and Intermediate

Exercises

56.1 Test your knowledge. Can you complete this table without looking at the opposite page?

noun	person	verb
crime	<i>criminal</i>	
murder		
theft		
robbery		
burglary		

56.2 Find five more pairs of words that have a similar meaning.

catch theft crime jail prison arrest get away
steal offence hit escape attack

catch – arrest
.....
.....

56.3 Complete the dialogues.

- 1 A: Is it being decided by a judge?
B: No, there will be a *jury*

2 A: Have the police caught the man?
B: Yes, he's under

3 A: Is she guilty?
B: No, the jury found her

4 A: He killed his wife?
B: Yes, he's under arrest for

5 A: Was it a serious crime?
B: No, just a minor
- 6 A: Will she go to prison?
B: No, she just has to pay a

7 A: Have you ever broken the law?
B: Yes, but I've never committed a serious

8 A: How do you think he will be ?
B: Well, it wasn't a very serious crime, so it'll probably be a fine.

56.4 Complete the news report.

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TODAY

BRISTOL FASHION THEFT

Two men are ¹ under arrest for ² stealing clothes from a warehouse* in Bristol. The two men ³ climbed into the warehouse late yesterday evening, ⁴ beat the guard and tied him up, then ⁵ stole a collection of expensive designer outfits ⁶ worth over £40,000. A passer-by saw lights on in the warehouse and rang the police, but the two men managed to ⁷ escape through a back door and then drove off with the stolen clothes. However, one of the men was later caught and ⁸ arrested at his home, and ⁹ police caught the second man just hours later hiding at a friend's house. Both men have now been charged with ¹⁰ theft and will appear before a judge in ¹¹ court on Monday. If they are found ¹² guilty, the two men will go to ¹³ prison for a number of years. The guard who was attacked has now been released from hospital.

* A warehouse is a large building for storing goods that are going to be sold.